Taking Flight

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Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

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Fandom:
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Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Swift Wind | Spirit, Scorpia (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Wrong Hordak (She-Ra), Micah (She-Ra), Netossa (She-Ra), Spinnerella (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra), Razz (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Canon, Fluff, Post-Canon, Action, Adventure, Post-She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018) Season 5, Near Death Experiences, Fusions, Magic, space, Lesbian Disaster Adora (She-Ra), Wings, Super Pal Trio (She-Ra), Spaceships, Adoruary 2022, Adoruary Horses, Very brief sexual jokes, Minor Perfuma/Scorpia (She-Ra), Mentioned Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra), Mentioned Entrapta/Hordak (She-Ra)

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by Anonymous

Summary

After a training session with Swift Wind and Bow, Adora decides to stop by and see Madam Razz for the first time since the war ended. Razz lets slip that there's a greater power that She-Ra possesses that Adora hasn't attained yet, the power to merge with her steed. Determined to gain this new power, Adora and Swift Wind try their best to merge together into a more powerful form, but their new skills are quickly put to the test when a space mission of Catra's goes badly, badly wrong. (Catradora, Canon, Fluff/Adventure)

Chapter 1

Chapter Summary

Adora, Bow, Swift Wind, pie and a lot of green goop.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Chapter 1

Adora ducked, as another arrow shot past her from the ground as she flew over the treetops in the whispering woods. She clung onto Swiftwind tightly, the pegasus flying at his fastest speed. Soaring through the air, Adora grabbed onto her steed tightly, a determined look upon her face.

She was ever alert, wanting to get to her destination without being shot out of the air by their opponent's weapons. Another arrow shot towards them, Adora deflecting it with her shield, knocking her and Swift Wind off balance with a loud thud.

"Woah, that was a close one!" Swift Wind exclaimed.

A rapid barrage of three arrows shot past them, Swift Wind dodging them narrowly. Adora pulled back on her steed's reins, looking around for some cover.

"Ugh! We're too high up!" Adora exclaimed. "Take us lower, buddy. We need to give him a harder target to shoot at."

"I feel like that'll actually make it easier for him to shoot at us," Swift Wind remarked.

"No, it won't, the treetops will give us better cover," Adora said. "Trust me."

Had Adora expected to be dodging arrow attacks from the ground today? No. Was she enjoying it? Yes. While this was all part of a training exercise, Adora found this whole thing very thrilling and with the war over... well she needed something to excite her. It got a bit boring just hanging around the castle all day.

Swift Wind dove down, the winged horse trying to stick closer to the trees. They flew forward, rushing towards the Crystal Castle, the finishing point of their exercise. If they were able to reach that without getting shot down, they'd win and if there was one thing Adora was always determined to do, it was winning.

"Almost there!" Adora called out, cackling with glee. "I think we're actually gonna make it!"

"Victory is nearly ours!" Swift Wind added.

Just then, another barrage of arrows shot from behind, Swift Wind, doing a loop in the air to avoid them. One of them only just skimmed past one of his wings.

"Ugh never mind!" Swift Wind exclaimed. "I think we might still be in trouble here!"

"He's just getting desperate!" Adora responded. "Keep moving, Swifty, we can make it!"

The spire of the crystal castle was almost in view, Adora tugging on Swift Wind's reigns as the pegasus soared closer and closer to their finishing line. She smirked confidently, feeling that they were indeed going to wind this. However, it was not to be, as another arrow shot from the ground at great speed, Swift Wind unable to dodge it.

The arrow exploded above their heads, covering Adora and Swift Wind in thick, green goop, causing them to tumble to the ground. Adora cried out as Swift Wind crashed to the forest floor, launched from her steed and landing on the dirt below with a mighty thud.

"Ow!" Adora groaned, her whole body covered in the sticky substance. "And... Ewww, gross."

Just then, the two of them heard the laughter of their opponent revelling in his victory, smirking as he put away his weapon.

"Okay, okay, you win Bow," Adora groaned as she picked herself up. She felt gross, the green slime seeping into her armour and covering every uncovered inch of skin. It felt cold too, like Adora had been covered in jelly. The more Adora tried to pull the goop off herself, the stickier it seemed to become.

"Ugh! I feel so funky," Swift Wind groaned as he picked himself up. "What even is this stuff?" he asked as he pulled a wing close to his face and sniffed it. "Oh God! This stuff reeks!" he nearly cried out. "I smell like a bathroom in the Fright Zone!"

"Sorry!" Bow said as he climbed down the tree he was seated at. "I made this stuff out of some new berries Perufma was growing. Just... don't tell her I used it for my arrows."

"Okay, but why does it smell so bad?" Swift Wind asked as he tried to shake the slime off his wings.

"Oh, I mixed in some of my cologne, just to give it a little kick," Bow explained proudly.

"I'll say," Adora said as she tried to shake the slime off her. "Whoof! Bow, seriously! Ease up on it! I'm sure Catra can smell us from here."

"Hey!" Bow whined. "My dads bought me this cologne for my birthday last year."

"Yeah, and they've got poor taste and can we just go already?!" Swift Wind pleaded, "I really need a bath right now! Actually, make that like ten baths and a whole week in quarantine."

"Same here," Adora agreed, trying to wipe her front. "I haven't smelled this bad since my cadet days... and even then the

showers weren't all that great in the Horde."

She made her way to mount onto Swift Wind, only for the winged horse to sidestep away. "Hey, come on, let me on!"

"Nope! Not happening!" Swift stated. "I've got enough of that gunk on me, I don't want any more!"

"Swifty, It'll only be for a minute," Adora stated before trying to mount up again. Only for the winged horse to trip her with a wing and push her away. He then snorted before spreading his goop-covered wings and ruffling them out, spraying Adora with even more gunk before taking off into the sky.

"Oh, real mature Swifty!" Adora cries out in indignation, wiping the added liquid off her face. "Oh god..."

Chuckling, Bow extended a hand to his downed friend. "Come on," he said, "I've got a skimmer nearby. let's get you home, Adora."

"Ugh, thanks Bow," Adora thanked him softly. "But next time we do this... just use the net arrow. I'm pretty sure this gunk is getting into places I didn't think stuff like this is supposed to."

"Eh don't worry, I'll further refine the formula for it," he reassured her, leading her to the skiff nearby.

A while later, Adora was on the skiff with Bow, the two of them heading back to Brightmoon. Adora had transformed out of her She-Ra form, but she was still covered in gunk. She sighed, wiping her hair with a towel, only for it to be covered in the same green gunk as in her hair.

"Ugh, it keeps getting worse," Adora groaned. "I need some shampoo in my hair pronto, otherwise i think I'm gonna start pulling hair out."

"I mean... you might look really cool with a short haircut," Bow remarked. "Catra did."

"Fair," Adora admitted, putting down the towel.

Bow looked around the area of the whispering woods they were driving through, recognising it, the trees packed tightly together and giving their surroundings an almost whimsical charm to them. "Hey... Isn't this the part of the forest where Madam Razz lives?"

"Yeah... I think it is!" Adora stated. "Maybe we can stop by her place and I can take a quick bath. Then Catra won't make me sleep on the floor for stinking like shit when we get home."

"She'd really do that?"

"Even if she's a good guy now, Catra can still be quite mean."

"Heh, I'll make a quick detour then," Bow admitted, tilting the control stick.

Swift Wind flew down towards them, having noticed them change direction. "Hey, where are you guys going? Brightmoon's the other way!"

"We're going to see Madam Razz!" Adora called back.

"Oh right!" Swift Wind acknowledged. "It'll be nice to see her! We haven't checked in on her since the end of the war."

The three of them soon arrived in the clearing where Madam Razz's hut was. However, the old woman clearly didn't seem to be around. As Adora got off the skiff, she looked around, feeling a little worried. While she didn't visit Razz often, she cared about her. After all, she was the one who helped her understand her role as She-Ra in the first place. Plus, she wouldn't have discovered the Heart Of Etheria without Razz's help.

"Huh, looks like nobody's home," Swift Wind admitted. "Think we came at a bad time?"

"Nah, she might be around," Adora said, looking around. "I think.."

Bow walked up to the hut, seeing that the fireplace was still lit. "She's lit her fire, so she couldn't have gone that far."

"So, what do we do?" Swift Wind asked. "I don't think it's polite to just use an old lady's bath without asking first."

Adora looked around, knowing that merely waiting wouldn't do much to ease her concerns. "I'm gonna go look for her. You guys just stay here in case she shows up."

"Don't take too long!" Swift Wind added. "This green goop can't be good for my feathers."

Adora wandered into the nearby trees, looking up at the setting sunshine above her. Being in the woods like this reminded her of the first night she found the sword... the night when her whole world was turned upside down. There had been so many changes in her life... and yet walking through the trees took Adora back to that fateful night. Stealing the skiff, bumping into Bow and Glimmer, transforming into She-Ra for the first time.

As Adora rested against a nearby tree, she had to smile a bit. With the magic of Etheria restored, the woods had a much softer glow to them. Before they'd felt foreboding and intimidating, now they felt welcoming and safe. Touching the tree with her hand, she could softly feel the magic flowing through it, as it flowed through everything now, plants, trees... and even Adora herself.

Suddenly, Adora was bashed on the head with a stick. "Ow!"

"Back away, Horde scum!" A voice shouted as the stick smacked Adora again.

"OWWW" Adora exclaimed. "Who-" She turned, seeing Madam Razz's diminutive form standing behind her. "Razz!"

"Adora, Dearie!" The old woman exclaimed. "I am sorry! But you know not to sneak up on an old woman like that!"

"S-Sorry!" Adora apologised, rubbing the back of her head.

Razz smiled. "I am happy to see you though! These forests have not been the same without you, especially since I started thinking straight again... then again, we might have spoken about this before."

Adora chuckled. "I'm happy to see you too... but I kinda came to ask if we could borrow your shower or something. I kinda got all covered in goop whole training and could use somewhere to clean myself up! Swifty as well!"

"Ah, you are fine, dearier!" Razz replied. "You can clean yourself up in my bath, but do stay for pie! I was just out picking berries!"

"Oh sure!" Adora agreed. "All that working out did give me quite an appetite."

"Wonderful!" Razz cheered before trying to pick up a huge sack that lay behind her.

"Here! Let me get that for you," Adora offered as she picked up the bag.

"Oh, thank you, dearie," Razz said. "I keep forgetting I'm not as young as I used to be. A word of advice Adora: don't grow old. Your body will begin to betray you," she said.

"Oh, I know that all too well," Adora remarked, still happy to hear from the rather eccentric old lady before her, following her back to the cabin.

After a short trek, Adora and Razz reached the cabin, with Bow and Swift Wind still waiting. "Oh my!" Razz exclaimed before curtsying. "Good evening, your majesty," she said to Bow. Both Adora and Swift Wind held back their laughter.

"Uhhh, Razz?" Bow wondered. "I think you might have me confused with someone else."

"But, Bow, you are the King of Brightmoon aren't you?" Razz wondered. "You and Glimmer tied the knot just a few months ago!

No wait, hang on, that hasn't happened yet. Ugh, stupid time loop, still confusing me."

Bow wanted to speak against Razz's explanation, but didn't. It was probably best that he didn't ask about his own future but then again... he did like the sound of being king.

"Well, I see Razz is her usual self," Swift Wind remarked.

"Now then, please come in," Razz stated, opening the door to her cabin. "We have a pie to bake!"

With no hesitation, Adora and Bow followed Razz inside, Swift Wind tailing, and having some difficulty with getting through the door, but he managed to squeeze in with a bit of difficulty.

Rummaging through her cabin, Razz pulled down a large wash basin. "I'm sorry dear, but I'm afraid you'll have to wash yourself in this," she said as she handed it to Adora. "Just take it out to the little stream out back to get water."

"It's alright," Adora replied as she took the tub and turned to leave.

"Hey! Where are you going?" Bow asked.

"Um, outside? To take my bath?" Adora answered. "This cabin's kind of small, no offence Razz."

"None taken, dear," she said.

"And well... I do prefer to have some privacy when bathing these days," Adora admitted, blushing.

"Except when she's with Catra!" Swift Wind declared.

"SWIFTY!" Adora growled, blushing furiously, to which Bow and the horse just giggled together, Adora heading outside to wash herself in embarrassment.

A while later, Adora was finishing drying herself in the middle of the clearing, putting her clothes back on. As she tied her hair into its usual ponytail, she felt relieved that the stench of Bow's goop was finally out of her system, though part of her was still worried that some of the smell was still in her clothes.

At least she was sure now that she wouldn't be sleeping on the bedroom floor that night when she got home.

"Are you done yet?" Swift Wind called from near Razz's cabin. "It should be my turn now!"

"Yes, I'm done!" Adora replied, putting on her jacket. "Come on over so I can wash you."

"Finally!" Swift Wind groaned, trotting out. "I think some of Bow's funk is burning my coat."

"And I think you're just being dramatic," Adora remarked as she took out a brush and began washing her Pegasus companion.

Not too far away from the hero and her steed, Bow and Razz were watching the two of them while Bow helped Razz bake her pie. "They have a strong connection," Razz remarked.

"I'll say," Bow said. "Apart from me, Catra and Glimmer. Swift Wind seems to be her best friend. It's almost like the pair have known each other forever."

"In a sense, they have," Razz said in a rather cryptic manner.

"Uhhhh excuse me?" Bow wondered, raising an eyebrow.

Razz smiled and gazed at Adora and Swift Wind like the ancient sage she was. "She-Ra and her steed have come in many forms for millions of years. Adora and Swift Wind are mere the latest incarnations of them, two souls forged in a warriors bond, standing with one another no matter what."

"Ugh, you pulled my feathers out!" Swift Wind complained, interrupting razz.

"Sorry, I'll be more gentle!" Adora apologised, brushing his wings.

Razz chuckled, walking away from the door and taking her pie out of the oven. "I'm surprised they haven't fused yet."

"Fusing?" Bow asked, but Razz didn't respond.

Soon, Swift Wind was clean and the group sat down to enjoy Madam Razz's pie. Adora was glad she and her friends got to have this after such a long day. With the war over, she'd truly learned to treasure these simple moments she shared with her friends, always allowing herself to slow down and let the world pass her by.

"Whew!" Adora exclaimed as she fell onto a chair, her arms and legs aching. "Who knew washing a winged horse would be so much work?"

"It wouldn't be if you didn't keep trying to rip my feathers off," Swift Wind groused, plopping his head on the table and legs on the floor. "Seriously, I thought you were gonna pull my whole wing off at one point."

"I said I'm sorry!" Adora exclaimed as Razz laid a slice of her freshly baked pie on the table for her guest. "Oh uh, thank you, Razz. The pie looks great by the way!"

"You're welcome," Razz said sweetly. "Now dig in, you've all got to keep your strength up."

Adora did so, chewing firmly on a piece of pie and sighing in content as her mouth filled with warmth. As she swallowed, her eyes widened... and then began stuffing her face with the rest of the slice. Bow had to chuckle at how much of a big eater the blonde girl was.

"So, what were you two talking about while we were busy?" Adora asked in between bites of her pie,

"We were talking about how you and Swift Wind are like joined at the hip at this point," Bow remarked.

"And I was surprised you haven't fused yet!" Razz chimed in.

Both Adora and Swift Wind nearly choked on their slices of pie, eyes widening to the size of dinner plates. "WHAT!?" they both exclaimed aloud.

"Yes, obviously She-Ra can fuse with her steed," Razz remarked.

"Wait, what do you mean fusing with my steed?" Adora wondered.

"Oh, you know silly! All She-Ra's can merge with their steeds to grow stronger and gain extra powers," Razz explained. "Everyone knows this!"

"I... I didn't," Adora replied, tapping her fingers together in embarrassment.

"Me neither and I share all her thoughts," Swift Wind added.

"Really? Well, that's surprising," Razz admitted. "It is common knowledge... or maybe it was common a long time ago and I forgot. That's possible."

"Wait, hang on," Bow stated. "I think I remember some of the artifacts in my dads' collections depicting ancient She-Ras. Some of them looked like they had wings or were centaurs."

"Sure that wasn't just because they might have been different species?" Adora wondered.

"I don't think so," Bow replied. "All the old carvings usually depict She-Ra riding her steed into battle... but these ones were the exceptions."

"Yes, She-Ra and her steed could combine!" Razz exclaimed.

"Did Mara ever combine with her steed?" Adora asked.

"Hmmm... no, I don't think she had one," Razz replied. "Then again, she wasn't using She-Ra's true powers. But you have changed, Adora! You are stronger than you have ever been... perhaps you could learn to merge with your flying horsie here!"

Adora thought for a moment. It sounded very appealing that were powers of her She-Ra form she still didn't know about and the ability to merge with Swift Wind for extra powers could come in handy... but Adora didn't know how in the world she was going to even attempt to do that.

But then again, if she could fly like Swift Wind could... that would certainly be worth whatever was needed to gain this new power.

"Yeah, that'd be pretty cool actually!" Adora realised. "Do you have any idea on how I could gain this power?"

Razz shrugged. "I do not. Just because I know a lot, doesn't mean I know everything! But... the old stories say that She-Ra and her steed must be in perfect mental balance for the merging to take place."

"Sounds as good of a start as any!" Swift Wind exclaimed, before he shut his eyes. "Uhhh... I'm thinking about Catra... How pretty she is... Swords... The First Ones... Uhhh I don't think this is working."

Razz chuckled. "It does not work that way, Horsie. You need to have a clear mind in order to fuse as one."

"So, what: we don't think about it?" Adora asked, clearly confused.

"Exactly," Razz stated. "Thoughts will only distract you. For you and your steed to be one, you need to depend on instinct. Let it come to you naturally."

"Well, that sounds easy enough," Bow said before taking another bite of his pie slice.

"Yes, easy in theory, difficult in execution," Razz stated.

Adora scoffed. "Yeah, for them," she stated proudly. "Me and Swifty here are thick as thieves. If anybody can master this whole 'fusion' thing, it'll be us. Right partner?"

"Amen to that, sister!" Swift Wind exclaimed, the pair high-fiving with one of his wings.

"We'll get this right!" Adora remarked. "I mean… how hard can it be?"

Chapter End Notes

Soooo I don't have this one fully edited yet, but I'll have it done and fully posted up by the end of the week. I had the idea for this story a while ago about Adora being able to merge with Swift Wind. I'm not gonna spoil anything further, but rest assured, it'll be a fun ride.

If you liked the fic please be sure to comment!

Chapter 2

Chapter Summary

Adora and Swift Wind try to fuse and Catra and her buddies go to spaaaaaaaace! And then things to hell pretty fast.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Chapter 2

"Okay Swifty, let's try this again!" Adora shouted, standing at the other end of the training yard. Her loyal steed stood opposite her, scraping his hooves on the ground. Her She-Ra form was practically glowing with magic and light, Adora fully hoping she and Swift Wind would be able to fuse today.

Confidently, Adora smirked, before sprinting straight at Swift Wind with all the enhanced speed her She-Ra form gave her. Swift Wind likewise broke into a gallop, both of them running towards one another, sparks of energy flying from Adora's feet as she charged forward.

With a mighty leap, Adora soared into the air, glowing with magical light, her pegasus joining her. The two of them tried to focus their thoughts, to clear their minds of everything... before ultimately, and unfortunately colliding with one another mid-air and crashing to the ground with a mighty thud.

"Ow!" Adora groaned. "Ugh, this is impossible."

"I get the feeling this is not supposed to be us literally pressing ourselves together physically," Swift Wind remarked.

"Well, we tried pretty much everything else," Adora admitted, disheartened. "But nothing's happened!" She sighed, plopping her hand under her chin. "Maybe this isn't something we can do. Razz might have just been making the whole thing up. I mean, she is old."

"Yeah, but she remembered Mara clearly enough," Swift Wind replied. "Look, why don't we try it one more time? Maybe we'll get it right."

Adora sighed getting to her feet. "Alright... but if this one fails, we need to try something different."

The two of them went to either end of the courtyard again, Adora mentally preparing herself. All morning, she and Swift Wind had been trying to tap into their powers, to merge into one being as Razz had stated. So far, all their attempts had been in failure... but Adora wasn't one to give up.

However, they'd failed so many times by now, that Adora was starting to doubt this was a power She-Ra even had. Perhaps the drawings of merged She-Ras were just some legend that people actually thought was true. It wouldn't be the first time such falsehoods had been spread through Etherian history.

Mentally clearing her thoughts again, Adora looked at Swift Wind again, smirking. "Okay, let's do this big guy!" She then sprinted at Swift Wind again.

"Yeah!" The pegasus cheered. "Adora and Swift Wind! Gonna combine into one awesome super thingy!"

The horse sang his song, charging towards Adora as both of them glowed with magic. They closed their eyes, before leaping into the air at one another. A tingle shot down Adora's spine, the blonde thinking for a moment that they'd finally perfected this... only for Swift Wind to crash on top of her, pinning her to the ground.

"OW!" Adora yelped in pain as she felt her horse crush her. "SWIFTY!"

"Did we fuse this time?" Swift Wind asked, innocently. "I don't exactly feel more like you."

"No... but I definitely feel you alright," Adora grunted, trying to push the pegasus off her back. "Can you like... get off me, please?"

"Ooop, sorry, my bad," Swift apologised as he got himself off of Adora. "So uhh... How long have we been trying to fuse again?"

"A few hours," Adora said as she dusted herself off and straightened her back. "Gahhhh... I think you nearly broke my spine there."

"Again, sorry, my bad, but in my defense, it was you who suggested the idea of us smacking into each other like this."

"What do you say we take a break?" Adora suggested. "I think we need to come up with an actual plan if we're gonna try this fusing thing."

"You go ahead and think," Swift Wind said as he trotted away. "I'm going to get something to eat."

"You just had breakfast!" Adora called him out.

"Ever heard of brunch?" Swift retorted. "Besides, crashing into you all morning has got me so hungry I could literally eat... okay, maybe I wouldn't go that far."

"Ugh fine," Adora responded. "I guess I'm feeling kinda hungry too."

Just then, Catra walked out into the training yard. "Hey Adora, I-" She blinked and looked down at Adora on the ground. "What are you doing down there?"

"Oh hey, Catra!" Adora chirped. "Just uhhh... getting some training in."

Catra groaned. "I repeat, what exactly are you doing? I've heard you and the horse wrestling all morning." She gave Adora one of her looks, the ones she usually gave whenever Adora did something dumb or silly. She folded her arms as she did so, rolling her eyes disapprovingly.

"Uhhhh... trying to merge with Swift Wind?" Adora responded, a sheepish grin on her face.

"Wait... merge, as you and him becoming one being?" Catra wondered. "What makes you think you can do that?"

"Madam Razz told us we could do it!" Swift Wind chimed in. "I mean, we haven't exactly had success yet, but hey, we're determined!"

Catra rolled her eyes. "Honestly, Adora, you're already an idiot. Why would you wanna fuse with your equally moronic pegasus here? Wouldn't that just make you even dumber?"

"Hey! It might be helpful!" Adora said, getting to her feet and transforming back to her normal self. "I don't know what my powers would be when we merge, but it might be an advantage for us at some point."

"Uh-huh, well in that case, maybe try and find a way to do it that doesn't give you as much head trauma," Catra snarked. She then poked the large poof in Adora's blonde hair. "That hair poof of yours can only protect you so much."

"Very funny," Adora remarked. "What are you doing here anyway?"

"Well, I just came to let you know I'm leaving for the day," Catra explained. "Entrapta has asked Scorpia and me to help her out with a little salvage mission of hers, up in orbit. We're gonna be taking a look at the disabled Horde ships, see if there's any junk onboard that might be useful."

"Oooh, that sounds fun!" Adora replied. "Sure you don't want me tagging along? It's... not like I'm doing anything right now."

"Nah, I'm good, Princess," Catra replied, stroking Adora's cheek. "Besides, I think I need this time with Entrapta and Scorpia. It's been a while since the three of us hung out as a... "super pal trio" as Scorpia calls us."

"Aw," Adora cooed. "That is so sweeeet!"

Catra scoffed as she shoved her girlfriend away. "You of all people should know I don't do sweet."

"I don't know," Adora said teasingly. "You can be pretty sweet when you want to." She wigged her eyebrows.

"Only to those who earned it," Catra said proudly.

"Like me?" Adora teases.

Wrapping her arms around her lover's shoulders, Catra looked deeply into Adora's steel-blue eyes. "Especially you, dummy," she purred flirtingly, before grabbing Adora's cheek and kissing her lovingly and wonderfully, lifting one leg up into the air and letting her tail coil around Adora's leg.

Noticing the two kissing, Swift Wind smirked."Hey, if you two are gonna be doing that stuff, I'll just uhhh... leave you in peace," Swift Wind remarked, smiling a little.

"Nah, it's fine," Catra replied, pulling out of the kiss. "Keep her out of trouble while I'm gone, okay bird brain?"

"Don't I always?" Swift Wind replied proudly.

Catra decided not to answer that question. Looking back at Adora, she gave her one more quick kiss before taking off. "I love you," she said softly.

"Awww! I love you too," Swift Wind swooned.

"Not you, you brain-dead narwhal!" Catra groaned, "I meant Adora!"

Adora just laughed at the antics before her. Seeing Catra and Swift Wind interact like this always brought a smile to her face. Namely because seeing them interact was comedy gold, but she decided to keep that fact to herself, just giggling in the background.

"I love you too," she replies to Catra. "Say hi to Entrapta and Scorpia for me," she tells her.

"No problem, Princess," Catra says before giving her one more quick kiss before departing. "I'll see you when I get back! Love you Adora!" she calls out as she leaves, skipping away towards the castle gates.

"Love you more!" Adora replied, smiling as she watched her love depart.

Swift Wind smiled. "You're a lucky woman Adora."

"I know," Adora sighed dreamily. "Alright, let's go get something to eat... but I think we definitely need to change things up for this fusing thing."

"What do you suggest?" The pegasus asked.

"Well, I think we need to go somewhere with an excess of raw magical energy," Adora stated. "It'll give us a bit of a power boost that might just be what we need. And I know just the place."

Once brunch was done, Adora and Swift Wind flew out to the whispering woods. Adora smiled as she and Swift Wind flew towards their destination, the Crystal Castle. if there was anywhere they could properly be focused on this whole combining thing, it was probably here.

The pegasus landed, Adora getting off his back, walking towards the decrepit, abandoned First One's ruin before them. The sight of this place sent chills down her spine.

"Well, we're here."

"So, now what?" Swift Wind asked. "Pretty sure Light Hope is a burned-out circuit board at this point, so we can't exactly go and ask her for help with this."

"No, but the Crystal Castle was the entrance to the Heart of Etheria," Adora replied. "Even if that's been disabled, there's still a larger quantity of magic here than anywhere else on the planet... and hopefully, training here might be able to help us fuse together."

"Honestly, at this point, I'd go and ask Horde Prime for help in us combining," The horse snarked.

Adora walked into the large ruin before her, memories flashing before her. Light Hope training her, trying to manipulate her into going down a path where the Heart Of Etheria could be activated, her fighting a desperate battle to reach the heart... and then Catra being at her side and the two professing her love.

Besides the Fright Zone, no other place on Etheria brought out such a mixture of good and bad memories for Adora. As she walked to the centre of the entrance, transforming into her She-Ra form, she reached out, feeling the flow of magical energy that ran through the planet, that felt its strongest here.

"Feels spooky being in here," Swift Wind admitted.

"Don't worry," Adora reassured him. "When I activated the failsafe, all the first one's tech here was completely fried. Nothing's gonna come get us. No holograms, no crazy brainwashed AIs."

"And no giant tentacle monsters right?" Swift Wind asked. "You mentioned that Shadow Weaver died here fighting one of those."

"Nope, definitely none of those," Adora replied.

"If you say so," Swift Wind replied hesitantly, his gaze constantly shifting around him. "But I'm still getting the creeps about this place. Wait, what about those freaky spider things?"

Adora sighed. "I told you; it's safe. You don't need to worry about anything here. So just get in here already."

Nodding, Swift Wind entered the crystal castle, the magical energy radiating within causing his fir to tingle and mane to stand on end. "So, what do we do?" he asked.

"Well, since our first attempts didn't really pan out," Adora said as she rubbed her possibly bruised sides, "I think it'd be better to start small. Let's try syncing our minds together first."

"…Huh?" Swift Wind asked, completely lost.

Adora groaned. "Ever heard of meditating?" she asked. "We should try and do that first."

"Oh! Why didn't you say so?" he said as he sat beside where she was standing. "I remember this, Perfuma's always doing it when everything goes out of her control."

Rolling her eyes, Adora sat down and crossed her legs, getting into a meditation pose like Perfuma had taught her, closing her eyes. She tried to clear her mind like Madam Razz had said, purging her mind of all her thoughts. Only for Swift Wind to chime in, interrupting her.

"Uhhh, Adora, how exactly do I do this?" he asked.

"I thought you said you'd seen Perfuma do it?"

"Okay, I kinda forgot because well, when I last saw her meditate, I'd downed a lot of apple cider." Swift Wind blushed. "It was uhh... well let's just say I don't take my ale well."

Sighing, Adora looked over at Swift WInd. "Okay uhhh... first you gotta sit down... wait, can you sit like this when you don't really have hands?"

"Let me try!" Swift WInd then plopped himself down on his rear, mimicking the pose Adora made with her hands with his hooves as best as he could. "Okay, it's kinda... well, I don't exactly feel comfortable like this, but I suppose it will work!"

"Good enough," Adora stated. "Now, we gotta close our eyes." Both her and Swift Wind closed their eyes in unison. "And then breathe deeply and easily."

Swift Wind began to inhale and exhale. Loudly. Adora's eye opened at him. "I said easily."

"Right, sorry," he apologised again, before starting to take slower, quieter breaths.

"Now, just clear yourself of all your thoughts, empty your mind and feel enlightenment. Become one with yourself."

Thus, the pair did sit, their body's still and minds open. They didn't think about a thing, allowing random thoughts to pass them by at a rapid pace. For that moment, the pair thought that they'd actually accomplish a fusion, but eventually, as a long, arduous hour ticked by, the pair again seemed to be getting nowhere

"OH MY FUCKING GOD THIS IS SO BORING!" Adora cried out after an hour., throwing herself back hard enough to fall over. On her back, she just stared up at the ceiling, growling in impatience. "HOW THE FUCK DOES PERFUMA EVEN DO THIS!?"

After letting out that explosion of rage, Adora panted, relaxing and trying to calm down. She was getting way too stressed out over this. At this point, she was very much convinced that the concept of She-Ra fusing with her steed was just something Madam Razz had made up in her ramblings.

"This is getting us nowhere," she mutters before picking herself up. "I don't know about you Swift Wind, but I'm beginning to think this whole 'fusion' thing is a load of crap. What do you think, buddy?"

The only thing that answered Adora was silence.

"Swifty?" Adora asked, but then she was answered by the sound of snoring from nearby.

Swift Wind had fallen asleep, his wings wrapped around himself. Adora sighed. She felt bad about having to do this, since they'd been at this all morning... but despite her growing suspicion that they weren't able to fuse, they still had to try at least every option they could think of.

"Swifty, wake up!" Adora urged.

The pegasus neighed, jumping to his hooves. "Huh, what? Where? Apples?" He then saw Adora. "Oh, it's you."

"Sorry."

"Don't be," he said before letting out a loud yawn. "So, did we fuse?"

"No," Adora groaned. "I'm starting to think we can't fuse."

"Well, it's only been a day," Swift Wind said, "maybe we can take a break and try again later."

"Yeah, maybe," Adora sighed as she looked up at the ceiling again. "I wonder how Catra is doing," she murmured. "She's probably having a lot more fun than we are."

Catra sighed as she leaned against the side of Darla on the landing pad in Dryl, looking at the time on her communicator. They should have left by now, but no, they were still stuck on

Etheria. She was getting quite frustrated, almost to the point she wanted to scratch her claws into the ship's hull.

But Catra knew Entrapta treated the ship like it was a lover, so she did her best to hold back from doing so. Instead, she just prayed that Scorpia would eventually show up soon. She... She had missed this, her, Entrapta and Scorpia hanging out together. She was just glad she had a second chance to be their friend now.

Entrapta was going through her various equipment with Wrong Hordak, humming a little tune to herself as she prepared for their little trip. She'd already kissed the regular Hordak reply, the former tyrant promising to look after her lab until she got back. Catra had to admit, despite them being complete opposites, Hordak and Entrapta were a cute couple.

"Do we have everything, Wrong Hordak?" she asked her assistant.

"Yes, mistress Entrapta!" Wrong Hordak replied dutifully. Catra raised her eyebrow at the fact the clone was still going by that moniker. One would have thought Wrong Hordak would have renamed himself by now to stop the confusion with his more infamous sibling.

Catra groaned, tapping her fingers against the ship. "Then what are we waiting for? Let's just go already. I swear we've been sitting out here for hours."

"Actually, only about 22.7 minutes have passed," Wrong Hordak stated. "So your statement there is largely inaccurate."

"Plus, we're waiting for Scorpia, remember?" Entrapta added.

"Well, she's certainly taking her sweet time," Catra grumbled.

As if on cue, the group then saw Scorpia running towards them, wearing her old jacket from the Crimson Waste and having a backpack thrown over her shoulder. She rushed towards them, panting heavily. "Hey girls, sorry I'm late!"

"Where were you?" Catra asked, trying not to sound too harsh. The last thing she wanted to be now was mean to poor Scorpia. "We've been waiting here... a while." She said, hopefully avoiding the ire of Wrong Hordak again.

"Sorry, sorry, so so very sorry," Scorpia apologised profusely. "But Perfuma insisted on making lunch for us to take on the trip." She plonked down her backpack, revealing it to be full of food. "See? I got some old ration bars for you, wildcat, potato chips, candy bars, cucumber sandwiches..."

"Ooooh, did she pack tiny snacks?!" Entrapta exclaimed.

"Sure did!" Scorpia confirmed. "Tiny cupcakes and cookies, your favourite!"

"Scorpia, you're the best!" Entrapta cheered. Entrapta squealed with glee as her hair quickly grabbed Scorpia's backpack. Using her hair, Entrapta walked onboard Darla, ready to salvage and repurpose any Horde technology she could get her machine oil greased fingers on.

Scorpia chuckled as she watched her friend enter the ship, moving to join her. As she did, she noticed Catra just leaning against the ship. "You okay, wild cat?" she asked.

"Hmm?" Catra murmured, too lost in her mind. Realizing who was speaking to her and what was said, Catra replied "Oh yeah, I'm fine, Big Gal. I'm just thinking about something."

Scorpia just smirked. "Adora? Let me guess, you and her got another cute date lined up?"

Catra flushed bright red, still not used to people teasing her about her love life. "Yes, but no, no dates lined up. I was mostly thinking about what she and Swift Wind were trying to do this morning."

"What were they trying to do?" Scorpia asks.

Catra laughed. "You wouldn't believe me if I told you," she said. "Adora thought they could actually fuse into some kind of super She-Ra."

For a moment, Scorpia just stood there, her face completely blank. Finally, after an uncomfortably long moment of awkward silence, Scorpia admitted to her friend, "Yeah that's uhhh... yeah wow, I'm not sure what to say about that."

"Guys, we're ready to go!" Entrapta called from the landing ramp.

Nodding, Catra and Scorpia headed onto the ship. Her thoughts for a moment shifted to Adora again, hoping her girlfriend wasn't going to hurt herself. Sure, she knew she didn't need to worry but she did anyway. They were dating, after all. It was her job to worry, especially considering Adora's tendencies to put everyone else before herself.

"Ah, feels like old times, eh Wildcat?" Scorpia said as they boarded. "Us three going on an adventure together."

"The last time we did this, we almost got killed by techno-organic First Ones creatures in the Northern Reach " Catra reminded her.

"Yeah, but we had fun right?" Scorpia chirped. "Besides, we're going into space, what could possibly go wrong?"

Once Catra and Scorpia were aboard, the ship's engines hummed into life, as it took off into space, flying into the sky at great speed. As the craft broke through the layer of clouds above and into the inky blackness of space surrounding Etheria. Standing at the bridge of the ship, Scorpia gazed in awe.

Her eyes widened around the stars surrounding her, planets and galaxies. Ever since she was a child, she'd always dreamed of being up in the stars. She shivered a little with euphoria, pressing her big claws together as she gazed in wonder at the majestic view from the cockpit.

Catra looked up, hearing Scorpia sniffle, a tear dripping down her cheek.

"Are you... Are you crying, Scorpia?" Catra asked.

"N-No, " Scorpia denied, before sighing. "Yes... It's just space is so beautiful."

"Yeah, it is, " Catra admitted. "I could get lost looking at the stars for hours."

Scorpia wiped the tear from her eye and then smirked. "Sure you're looking at stars and not into Adora's eyes?"

"S-Shut up!" Catra snapped, flushing bright red, to which Scorpia just giggled playfully.

Darla flew through space, soon approaching the orbit of the large, hulking derelict ships of Horde Prime's armada. Once, these ships had been blockading Etheria, Prime's forces launching their invasion of the planet from these vessels. Now they just sat in orbit, gathering metaphorical and sometimes literal space dust.

"Hard to believe these ships were attacking us not that long ago, " Scorpia admitted. "What happened to then anyway? They're all like shut down."

"When Adora activated the failsafe, it sent out one hell of an ion pulse that disabled these ships, " Entrapta explained. "The clones onboard were transported to Etheria's surface by their emergency teleports, leaving the ship's disabled and abandoned in orbit."

"So we're alone here right?" Scorpia asked. "No one's left? Not even like those weird robots?"

"Completely!" Entrapta chirped. "And those robots will have been deactivated anyway."

"You sure?" Scorpia asked. She looked over the decrepit ship in front of her, a feeling of dread creeping over her. She felt a

shudder overcome her as visions of her time being chipped came back. She wasn't as traumatised over it as the other princesses... but she would be lying if she said she wasn't feeling a rush of anxiety at that moment.

"Oh, relax!" Entrapta assured as she leapt onto Scorpia's shoulders. "Even if there was any biological life on that ship that wasn't the clones, they're long since dead. Lack of oxygen you see."

"Looks like we're gonna be putting on our spacesuits again then," Catra stated.

"Spacesuits?" Scorpia wondered.

"Yeah! I made one just for you!" Entrapta chirped, rummaging through her things before pulling out a recently sewn nylon garment and helmet. "It's even got space for your tail and claws to slip into as well."

"Awwww, Entrapta, you shouldn't have!" Scorpia cooed, her eyes widening.

"But I did do it... because without it you'd be dead otherwise!" Entrapta chirped.

Catra rolled her eyes as she picked up her spacesuit, knowing this was definitely going to be one of those long missions.

They soon approached one of the Horde ships, Entrapta piloting the ship to dock to one of the airlocks on the ship's exterior. Once the ship was firmly attached via its landing legs magnetised to the other craft's hull, the crew boarded through the docking port, wearing their spacesuits.

Scorpia grumbled as she shifted about in her new suit. Since this was her first time being in space, this was the first time she'd worn a spacesuit. Like the others, it had been tailor-made to suit her, with slight red highlights like her usual outfit and covers for her tail and claws.

Catra looked around as she, Entrapta, Scorpia and Wrong Hordak floated through the airlock onto the derelict Horde ship, feeling the weightlessness around them. She saw objects that hadn't been nailed down floating in the air and the dust that had gathered pinned in place as if time itself had stopped.

"Woah, no gravity is weird!" Scorpia admitted, stumbling through the airlock and trying not to accidentally bump into anything.

"You'll get used to it!" Entrapta chirped. "I find it very relaxing."

Scorpia then saw Wrong Hordak, who was floating over to a nearby control panel. She then realised that the Horde Clone wasn't wearing any kind of space helmet like they were.

"Hey, he's not wearing a helmet!" Scorpia exclaimed. "Cloney, put one on, you're gonna suffocate!"

"Do not worry, sister," the clone replied. "Our species were genetically altered to be able to survive in any environment."

"Even the vacuum of space?" Scorpia wondered.

"Oh yes, even that," he explained. "A lot of the outposts on the fringes of the old empire were on barren worlds with no atmosphere whatsoever."

"That's... huh, that's kinda handy," Scorpia remarked.

Catra looked around, the darkened hallway making her worry a little. Even though this ship was completely abandoned, she still felt as though someone was still here, Prime's all-seeing eyes watching their every move. But she knew that was just her anxiety talking. She'd feel better once some damned lights were turned on.

"Have you got the power working yet?" she wondered.

"Almost," Wrong Hordak admitted. "These circuits haven't been used in a while."

Just then, there was a low humming, as the lights in the corridor flickered to life, the circuits in the walls glowing their sickly green hue and white walls giving the whole ship a sterile feeling, that all impurities had been purged from it, fitting since this was a Horde ship.

"There all done!" Wrong Hordak confirmed. "I have also adjusted the atmosphere so you will be able to breathe easily, sisters."

"Huh, he sure is a handy fellow isn't he?" Scorpia remarked.

"I do my best to please," Wrong Hordak said.

With the power restored to the ship and atmospheric controls set, Catra wasted no time taking off her helmet. As soon as she did, however, she coughed, the stale air of the ship flooding into her lungs. "Hey, Wrongy, think you can do something about the air?" she asked. "Feels like I'm smelling the fumes from your brother's lab here."

"And some gravity would be nice too," Scorpia added as she tried to swim through the air.

"I shall have proper air circulation and artificial gravity initiated within the moment, sisters," Wrong Hordak stated as he fiddled with the ship's controls.

In no time, the air began to circulate again, blowing away the stagnant miasma Catra and the crew were forced to breathe. Soon after, gravity returned to the ship, allowing everyone onboard to keep a solid footing. Scorpia was quick to flip herself over and land on her feet before she crashed onto her face.

"Nice job, Wrong H!" Entrapta cheered as she hugged him tightly.

Catra chuckles as she watches the interaction between the hyperactive inventor and clone She decided to let the pair have their moment and explore the ship on her own. Something about this vessel made her feel... curious. She'd only ever been on Prime's command ship before now.

She soon regretted that decision, as she began feeling a creeping dread overcome her. When she looked at the equipment on the walls, the panels, even the green lights surrounding her, horrible memories began to manifest, namely the memories of what she'd done to hurt her beloved Adora.

She quickly shook her head, forcing the thoughts out. She had to remind herself that she hadn't been herself when Prime had chipped her. He had been the one who had forced her to hurt Adora, forced her into his service, his light without her consent. But still, the thought of it all made an ugly lump form in Catra's throat.

She turned a corner, too caught up in her own mind to realize where she was going. When she finally paused to look around, a wave of even more sickening nausea overcame her.

Somehow, she had found herself standing before what she could only describe as her "worst nightmare": the medical bay of the ship. Operating tables and stasis capsules covered much of the space inside, with pathways only barely wide enough for a single person to walk through connecting everything together.

Those were bad enough to look at, but what really sent her stomach roiling, causing her to clutch her midsection and cover her mouth, in an attempt to prevent herself from vomiting, were the four glowing pools of green fluid on the far side of the medbay. She saw her repeated nightmares flash before her eyes: Horde Prime's wicked gleam, the painful devices and tools, the chip forced into her neck, the excruciating pain she was subjected to, it was all too much for her.

She fell to her knees, clutching her knees and tears falling without her consent. "No..." she muttered, over and over again, her scars opened and pain constricting her. "Not again... not this again..."

A large hard claw fell onto her shoulder. Looking up, she saw her friend Scorpia looking over her, concern marring her face. "Hey,"

she said, "if you need a moment, you can go back to Darla and just, I don't know, stay there until you're all better."

Catra took in a shuddering breath, trying to centre her obviously fraying nerves. "No!" she hissed, resolute in her conviction. "No!" she said louder, more clearly. "I'm alright, I just need a moment."

She then chuckled, finding something darkly humorous about all of this. "I thought I'd be over all that crap by now," she said. "Guess I'm not as strong as I thought I was." She wiped her tears, hoping that would lighten the mood, but the dread came back again and she found her hands wrapped around her chest again.

"You know, it akes a lot more strength to know when to back off from something," Scorpia added. "Seriously Wildcat, if this is too much for you, you can leave and let Entrapta and I do all the heavy lifting."

"Seriously, I'm fine," Catra states adamantly. "I just, need some time to set things right with myself... and besides, I'd miss out on all the fun without you two."

Scorpia wanted to call out her friend's self-destructive tendency to bury her pain and force her back onto Darla so she can recover in a comfortable environment, but decided against it. She realised that this was one of Catra's biggest personal demons, and that in the end, it had to be Catra who had to lay it to rest.

"Alright," Scorpia forfeited extending a claw to help her friend up. "But just so you know, you don't have to go it alone."

"Tat's the thing," Catra replied, standing up. "I know I'm not alone anymore... not as long as I've got friends like you, Scorpia."

"Hey," Scorpia scoffs, blushing slightly and brushing off the touching moment in a nonchalant manner. "What are friends for?"

"Oh, by the way," Scorpia suddenly said before turning back to the felid. "I've been meaning to ask. Do you think I should ask

Entrapta to make some tweaks to my spacesuit?"

"What's wrong with it?" Catra wondered in confusion.

"Oh nothing, really," Scorpia stated. "It's just that mine's not as cute as yours."

Catra growled, blushing again. Scorpia knew all her buttons... but Catra wasn't going to snap back at her. She'd learned to accept this now. "Please don't."

"But it is!" Scorpia chirped. "Those ears are precious!"

"Stop!" Catra groaned, flushing red and covering her face.

Scorpia chuckled. "Come on, I'd hate to get lost on a ship like this."

Soon, the group arrived on the ship's bridge, everyone in awe of the view of the stars out of the large windows. Catra made her way over the captain's chair, plopping herself down on it, feeling a sense of power rush through her.

Entrapta squealed at the various consoles and equipment on the bridge, jumping around in her usual hyperactive manner. "This is amazing! Horde Prime may have been an omnicidal tyrant, but he sure knew how to build ships!"

Wrong Hordak walked over to a nearby computer, opening a small access port for Entrapta. "Here you go, Mistress."

"Thank you!" Entrapta chirped. "I'll be able to access the central core from here!" She pulled out one of her portable computers and connected it to the console with a cable, typing away at a holographic keyboard to access the ship's systems. "Fascinating..."

"Think you'll find anything interesting?" Scorpia wondered, as she leaned against a console, accidentally crushing it with her

muscular arm. She gulped, moving away nervously, but neither Entrapta nor Wrong Hordak seemed to notice.

"Probably!" Entrapta chirped, looking through the data scrolling before her eyes "Ship's like this have probably travelled across countless star systems. There's probably more data on the rest of the universes here than I could ever hope for."

Catra laid back and thought for a moment. Sitting in the captain's chair honestly felt very empowering to her... But then she regretted having such thoughts. She wasn't the powerful Force Captain anymore, she was just Catra, plain and simple Catra. She gazed over at Entrapta and Scorpia, watching them.

Entrapa hummed away as she began the download of all the relevant data from the ship's central mainframe. Her eyes widened so much when she saw all the data scrolling past. Scorpia's eye twitched as she saw how much data was being downloaded. How could Entrapta read it all so quickly?

"So much information!" she said enthusiastically. "The navigation data from this one ship alone would help me in completely mapping out this entire galactic quadrant!"

"Uhhh... Can you repeat that in Etherian?" Scorpia wondered, scratching her head.

"The stuff in the computer will help us see more of space, " Catra translated.

"Oh neat!" Scorpia replied. "I think?"

"Trust me, neat doesn't even begin to describe this!" Entrapta stated as she scanned over the data before her. As she did, her eyes widened and sparkled more and more, completely enraptured in what she was saying. "I really wish I brought my-" she started to say before Wrong Hordak interrupted her.

"Data pad?" he asked, holding said pad out before Entrapta. With a giddy squeal of excitement, she grabbed her pad and rapidly

jotted down as much data as she could.

"Thank you! I thought I'd left this back on the ship!"

"I would never let you forget such an important item, mistress," Wrong Hordak responded.

"Well, she looks happy," Catra chuckled as she stretched out on the captain's chair.

"And you seem comfortable," Scorpia quipped in a teasing manner.

"Yeah," Catra yawned as she gave an exaggerated stretch. "Being this awesome is a burden, but it's my burden to bare."

Then Scorpia looked at the pad next to Entrapta and got an idea. "Hey, anyone feel like taking a group photo? "

"Ooooh, I do!" Entrapta chirped.

"Same for me!" Wrong Hordak added.

Scorpia beamed at Catra. "Catra? You joining in?"

"Fine, " Catra grumbled, leaping down and going over to them. Even if she wasn't a fan of her photo getting taken, she didn't want to disappoint her friends.

As everyone posed for the photo, Catra couldn't help but smile. She wouldn't admit it, but she was very glad to be here with Entrapta and Scorpia, to be given another chance of being their friend. As Entrapta held out the pad in front of them with her hair tendrils, Catra leaned in.

"Okay, everyone say She-Ra!" Scorpia chirped.

"She-Ra!" everyone then cheered in unison, as Entrapta took the picture.

Catra took the pad, looking at the image. It made her feel... good actually. Most pictures of herself she usually hated, but she felt much warmer, happier feelings from this one. When they got back home, she was definitely going to consider hanging this on her wall.

"Huh, you got my good side, Entrapta, " she remarked.

Suddenly, the group heard the sound of an alarm blaring and red lights flashing all over the bridge. Scorpia jumped in panic, clutching onto Wrong Hordak.

"Uh, what's that about?!"

"Probably nothing!" Entrapta chirped. She then went to a nearby monitor, but as she saw the information on the screen, her expression fell. "Oh... It's definitely not nothing... This is bad... very, very bad."

"Uh, what's happening?" Catra asked, concerned.

"The sensors just came online... And they've detected a small meteor storm heading right for us!" Entrapta exclaimed.

"Wait, that's not bad right?" Scorpia asked, nervously tapping her pincers again. "I mean, if they're only tiny ones, we should be okay."

"No, you moron, it's less about the size and more about the speed, " Catra explained.

"Yes and these ones are travelling at such an intense velocity, they'll rip this ship apart!" Entrapta urged.

"Can we get back to Darla?" Catra asked.

"Not enough time!"

"Okay, power up the shields?"

"Not enough time for that either!"

"Weapons!"

"Nope!"

"Not giving us many options here, Entrapta!" Catra growled.

"If I may suggest, we might have enough power to get the ship's manoeuvring thrusters online, " Wrong Hordak chimed in. "We could try and move the ship out of the way to avoid the impact!"

"Yes! Good boy, Wrong Hordak!" Entrapta praised the clone.

"Get on that!" Catra ordered. "Entrapta, how long do we have until the meteors hit us?"

"Based on their trajectory, I'd estimate we have about three minutes until impact!" Entrapta stated.

"And how long will it take getting those thrusters online?"

"Roughly two minutes!" Wrong Hordak replied.

Everyone let out a relieved sigh: they had plenty of time to get out of the way. Suddenly, alarms began blaring in the cockpit. Multiple "WARNING" signs popped up on the controls, followed by a holographic schematic of the ship. A portion of the schematic flashed an angry red.

"There's an obstruction in the fuel line!" Wrong Hordak stated. "They need to be flushed before the thrusters can be fired!"

"On it!" Scorpia announced, wasting no time to bolt to the engineering console. Thankful for what little Horde technology training she remembered, she quickly got to work in flushing the fuel lines. Suddenly, there was another warning light in front of Scorpia. "Uhhhh, that's not good!"

"Scorpia, hurry it up!" Catra urged.

"Hey, I'm doing my best!" Scorpia shouted. She started kicking and smacking the console with her claws, hoping that would fix the issue. "Come on you stupid machine, work for me!"

"One and a half minutes until impact!" Entrapta exclaimed.

Scorpia grunted, slamming her claw on the table. There was a confirming ping as a green light flashed on her display. "Okay, it's done!"

"I'm charging the thrusters up now!" Wrong Hordak replied.

Catra watched as she looked through the windows on the warship's bridge, seeing the small storm of meteors hurtling towards the small fleet of derelicts, flaming trails following behind them. Every moment they got closer made Catra's anxiety rise up even higher.

"A little faster guys!" " Catra called out.

"Almost, got it!" Wrong Hordak shouted.

"Fifteen seconds to impact!" Entrapta reported.

Catra gritted her teeth. They weren't gonna do it in time. She looked at the others, knowing they had to do their best to try and survive this. "Alright, get to cover and grab onto something!"

The meteors then crashed into another one of the derelict ships with a massive explosion, breaking it apart on impact. Large chunks of debris flew out, crashing into other ships nearby and tearing them apart, a massive storm of debris heading towards the ship Catra and the others were on.

"Thrusters online!" Wrong Hordak called out, but it was sadly too late.

As the warship tried to move out of range, several large chunks of debris struck it from the side, causing massive damage and knocking it towards the planet below. Large explosions were

heard all over the ship, the bridge shaking violently and knocking the group about.

Fortunately though, Catra and her friends had managed to survive... though Catra had a gut feeling they had bigger problems.

"Huh... We're alive?!" Scorpia exclaimed. "You did it, Wrong Hordak!"

"Uhhh... we're not out of this yet!" Entrapta stated. "Those impacts shifted our orbit greatly... in fact, we've been knocked *out* of orbit!"

"Oh shit!" Scorpia swore.

"We're gonna crash!" Wrong Hordak exclaimed.

Chapter End Notes

> Just finished editing this chapter so I figured i'd post it right away. Anyhoo, I'll leave you on that cliffhanger for a few days before I post the last chapter. I hope you're enjoying the story so far!
>
> If you liked the chapter please be sure to comment!!!

Chapter 3

Chapter Summary

Catra falls from the sky and Adora awakens her new power... But is she too late to save her love?

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Chapter 3

Catra panted as she and her friends ran down the corridor of the Horde ship, hoping to reach Darla in time. They had to get off this ship before it crashed. Loud creaks and explosions were heard, as the ship slowly started to fall apart as it fell into the gravity of the planet below.

Alarms blared loudly all around the group as they rushed down the length of the ship towards Darla, Catra hoping they would make it. Was she surprised that everything had gone to hell in a handbasket? Not exactly, these sorts of endeavours rarely went well from her personal experience.

"Entrapta, how long before we start entering the atmosphere!" She shouted, as they ran around a corner, the ship shaking again and nearly knocking Catra down.

"Not sure! We're still accelerating!" Entrapta responded, looking down at the datapad she had gripped in her hair tendrils. "I might be able to calculate better once this thing reaches terminal velocity!"

"Well, I had a feeling we'd be having an adventure up here!" Scorpia admitted. "Didn't think we'd be fleeing for our lives though!"

"Eh, that's what makes this whole thing exciting!" Catra remarked, trying to use humour to deflect everyone's fears, leaping around a large piece of debris that fell towards her.

Suddenly, a strong shudder and a deafening boom filled the ship as it entered the planet's atmosphere, knocking everyone off their feet. As they fell, sparks flew about and large pieces of metal came crashing down from the ceiling, Catra rolling to one side to dodge some of the rubble.

As Catra got to her feet, she quickly checked herself, seeing if she had sustained any injuries. Fortunately for her, she was unharmed. "Everyone alright?" she groaned as she picked herself up.

"I think so," Entrapta groaned, her hair pulling her up and pushing off some metal that fell on her.

"I am well, thank you for asking," Wrong Hordak replied before helping Entrapta to her feet.

"Help!" Scorpia cried out. Quickly turning to her friend, Catra saw that she was trapped under a heavy beam that had crashed down. She tried to push it off, but it proved to be too heavy even for her to budge. The arachnid strained, trying to free herself but it proved to be to no avail.

Quickly running over to her side, Catra wasted no time in grabbing the beam of metal and helping her lift it. Entrapta and Wrong Hordak soon joined, both of them grabbing different sections of the beam and lifting. As soon as it lifted slightly, Catra growled "go! Now!" to Scorpia. Taking her friend's advice, Scorpia shimmied out from under the bar. When she was far enough away from the bar to not get crushed by it or crushed underneath, the rest of the group dropped it with a loud crash.

"Thanks," Scorpia groaned as she rubbed her ankle. "Ow..."

"You okay?" Catra asked, worried about her friend's ankle suddenly seeming wider.

"I don't think so," Scorpia replied. "I think I rolled my ankle when that beam fell on me." She hissed as she gently massaged the aforementioned ankle. "Oh heck, it hurts so much."

"Lean on me," Catra insisted, sliding herself under Scorpia's arm to support her. "It's not far until the ship!"

"I... I won't make it!" Scorpia sighed. "Just go, Wildcat... I'll only slow you down."

"No way, I don't abandon my friends, not anymore," Catra remarked. "Besides, Perfuma would have me skinned into a fur coat if anything happened to you."

Eventually, they managed to make ti the airlock where they'd docked. Catra was about touch the control panel... when the whole ship shook violently, knocking them down to the floor. When Catra got up, she stared in horror as Darla was forcefully ripped away from the airlock, tumbling into the atmosphere.

"Oh, fucking hell!" Catra roared. "Can nothing go right today?!"

"The ship!" Wrong Hordak cried out.

"Don't worry, Darla will be fine!" Entrapta reassured them. "Her automatic return systems will kick in and she'll fly back to Dryl!"

"Yeah, but we're kinda stuck on a crashing ship here!" Catra roared. "Ugh, Wrong Hordak, are the escape pods working on this heap of junk?"

Wrong Hordak looked at the holographic interface on his wrist, shaking his head. "No, I'm afraid the escape circuits were damaged in the collision. We can't launch the escape pods."

"And there's probably no time to repair them," Catra theorised.

"Well, we're really screwed now!" Scorpia shouted.

Thinking, Catra knew there had to be some way they could survive this. if they couldn't use an escape pod, nor their own ship, perhaps... It was a risky idea but Catra didn't see any other option. Plus, they could potentially minimise any damage to the planet below.

"No, I've got an idea," Catra then said. "Wrong Hordak, can you get the main engines online?"

"Possibly! But ships like this weren't designed for landings," he explained.

"Well, we're not gonna try landing this thing, just try and steer it at an angle so it can have a controlled crash somewhere," Catra explained.

"A controlled crash!?" Scorpia exclaimed. "Are you crazy!? We could tear the ship up on re-entry!"

"Well, if you've got a better idea, I'd love to hear it!" Catra shot back. When Scorpia didn't speak, Catra knew she had her. "That's what I thought," she stated before turning to Wrong Hordak. "Wrong Hordak, get to the engineering console and fire up those engines. Plot a course for the largest uninhabited area we can reach, the ocean, the Crimson waste, I don't care."

"Understood," Wrong Hordak replied.

"Entrapta, carry Scorpia to the cockpit. There's no time to get the medbay and patch her up, so we'll have to keep her there until this is over," Catra ordered.

"On it," Entrapta said as she wrapped Scorpia up in her hair like a cocoon and carried her.

Catra and the others soon bolted for the bridge, Catra leaping into the captain's chair. She looked ahead, seeing the firey flames of re-entry before her. It looked as though hell itself was surrounding them. Entrapta laid Scorpia against an intent on the wall to rest

before she and Wrong Hordak went to a nearby console to bring the engines online.

"Engines are online!" Entrapta stated.

Catra nodded, pressing a few buttons on a console before her, activating the manual control interface. A holographic display appeared before her, which Catra pressed onto with her hands. "Okay, hang on everyone!"

Grabbing the holographic controls tightly, Catra then began to pilot the massive ship, trying to pull it out of its dive. Wrong Hordak was at another console, monitoring the engine power. Catra grunted as she heard the ship creak and strain, trying to push against the massive G-forces against her ship.

"Divert all power to thrusters!" Catra ordered.

"I'm giving it all I've got!" Wrong Hordak cried out. "The engines can't take the strain!"

"Make them!" Catra ordered. "I'm getting us out of this alive, one way or another!"

Scorpia clung to the wall, as the bridge kept shaking violently, the ship plummeting down to Etheria below. As the ground approached closer and closer, she started to tap her claws again fearfully, gulping in pure and utter terror. "Oh no no no no no no no no..."

"Scorpia, we're not gonna die!" Catra shouted, trying to calm her friend. "Just hang on!"

Then, another violent wave shook the bridge, the group hearing a very loud creak and crash from the rear of the ship, as the ship itself had actually broken in half, the rear end of the ship falling off and plummeting down on its own trajectory towards the Etherian sea.

"We... We just lost the main engines!" Wrong Hordak shouted.

"Don't worry, we're still flying half a ship!" Catra called out.

"Uh, Catra! I've got more bad news!" Entrapta reported.

"Keep piling it on, 'Trapta!" Catra remarked. "Things couldn't possibly get any worse than this!"

"I've calculated where our ship is gonna crash. We're gonna crash right on top of Brightmoon!"

"That's worse!" Scorpia exclaimed. "Catra, we've got to warn them! Everyone will be killed!"

Catra nodded. "Wrong Hordak, get me Sparkles on the horn now!"

Meanwhile, in Brightmoon, Glimmer and her father King Micah were running towards the war room, a red alert being raised all over Brightmoon. Glimmer had never seen her kingdom in such a crisis, not since the end of the war. Whatever was going on, it was clearly something that was putting them all in danger.

And to think she'd hoped to have a relaxing day today, having a picnic with her father in the garden by the memorial to her mother and spending some time with Bow that evening. But well, with their lives, the quiet moments tended to be pushed aside whenever situations like this occurred.

"What do you think it is, sweetie?" Micah wondered. "Think we're under attack?"

"Not sure, dad, but I hate that it ruined our picnic," she grumbled.

The two of them ran into the war room, having run as fast as they could. When she got there, Glimmer saw Bow and Netossa standing beside the table, gazing at a hologram of the nearby surroundings, while Spinnerella was standing beside the war table working on a console.

Bow turned, seeing his girlfriend and breathed a sigh of relief. "GLimmer, thank goodness!"

"Bow, what's going on?!" She demanded, as alarms blared all around her. "I was out in the garden with my dad and then I heard alarms going off everywhere."

"I had to put the entire kingdom on full alert," Bow explained, pointing to the hologram displayed before them, of the planet Etheria and something heading towards it. "We just picked up something entering Etheria's atmosphere. We can't pinpoint where it's gonna land, but it's big."

"Do we have a visual?" Glimmer wondered.

"Nothing yet," Netossa stated. "The thing is moving so fast we can't get a clear look at it with the scanners."

"Think it's a meteor?" Micah theorised. "Those things tend to come down pretty damn fast."

"No, we'd have had more warning if this was a meteor. This is something else alright." Netossa then noticed something on her screen. "Hang on... I think I've enhanced the scans enough. Spinny, blow up the image for us, will you?"

"Yes, darling," Spinnerella replied.

A hologram then appeared, showing them the sight of the object entering Etheria's atmosphere. Glimmer's eyes widened, seeing that it was in fact one of the Horde ship's that had been stuck in orbit since the end of the war, currently engulfed in flames as it flew through the upper atmosphere.

"It's a horde ship!" she exclaimed.

"Must've been knocked out of orbit somehow," Netossa realised. "Wait, weren't Catra and the others going up to one of those ships today?"

"You don't think..." Bow spoke, before he gulped. "Oh boy."

Spinnerella noticed a small display next to her beeping. "Glimmer, we're getting a transmission... it's from Catra."

"Catra?" Bow wondered.

"Where is it coming from?" Glimmer asked.

Spinnerella gulped. "It's coming from... the ship."

"Put her through," Glimmer ordered.

Just then, a large holographic display appeared before their heads, showing Catra, Scorpia and Entrapta on the flaming bridge of the horde ship. Catra looked beaten up, sweat beading down her brow as she was clutching the controls of the crashing Horde cruiser.

"Sparkles?" She asked. "Are you reading me? Please tell me the radio on this heap of junk is still working."

"Only just," Glimmer answered. "Where are you? What's happening up there?!"

"The Horde ship I'm on got knocked out of orbit by a meteor strike," Catra explained. "We tried to slow it down, but it just broke in half. One half is gonna ditch in the ocean, but our half is gonna crash right on top of Brightmoon! You need to evacuate the whole damn city now!"

"What the hell?!" Glimmer exclaimed. "Right, right, on it! I'll get the other princesses to help... but what about you? You'll be killed!"

"I'm trying to use the forward thrusters to slow our descent. Hopefully, they still work. It won't change our trajectory that much, but it might slow us down and buy you some more time to everyone to safety."

"I can teleport you out of there!" Glimmer suggested.

"We're going too fast for that!" Catra shouted. "You won't be able to get a lock on us! Just get everyone out of brightmoon now! The fewer people killed, the better!"

"She's right," Micah stated. "Even your mom wouldn't have been able to pull off something like that, little one."

"But what about you?!" Glimmer exclaimed, looking at Catra. "I can't just let you, Scorpia and Entrapta die like that!"

"Compare to the complete obliteration of Brightmoon, four people dying wouldn't be that bad a loss!" Catra stated.

"Like hell, it wouldn't!" Glimmer countered angrily, Bow restraining her slightly. "How do you think Perfuma would react when she finds out Scorpia's not coming back?" God Damn it Catra, what about Adora!?"

Suddenly, at the mentioning of the hero of Etheria, an idea lit up in Glimmer's mind. "Adora…" she murmured to herself before exclaiming "that's it!"

"What's it?" Catra asked.

"No time Catra," Glimmer quickly said, "I have to contact Adora!"

"Why?!"

"She might be able to help you," Glimmer remarked. "She and Swift Wind left earlier, but if they can reach you in time..."

"Sparkles, even with her horse flying at full speed, she won't be able to get us out of this," Catra argued. "Get evacuating now!"

"But Catra-"

"Just do it!" Catra shouted. "I'm activating the forward thrusters now!"

Glimmer sighed. "Fine... I'm sorry, Horde Scum."

"So am I, Sparkles," Catra admitted. "When you call her, Adora... tell her I love her with all my heart."

Then the transmission closed, Glimmer tearing up a little. The Queen then steeled herself, knowing what she had to do.

"Bow, Dad, Netossa, send out a call to all the princesses," She stated. "We're evacuating everyone out of Brightmoon now!"

Micah nodded. "We're on it, Pumpkin. Come on kids!" He then ran out of the room, Bow turning around a moment to look at Glimmer.

"Glimmer... are you..."

"No, Catra was right," Glimmer argued. "She won't be able to save them... not this time."

Bow nodded. "I understand."

As he left, Glimmer went back to the console, looking at Spinnerella again, "Get Adora on the line, Spinnerella and fast."

"You got it," she responded, quickly trying to contact Adora. The wait between rings was agonisng for Glimmer, who impatiently tapped her fingers on the table.

"Please pick up!" Glimmer hissed as the comm line continued to ring.

Adora sighed as she pressed her forehead against Swift Wind, grunting as she held his hooves in her hands, the two of them trying to press themselves together. All day, all goddamn day they'd been trying to fuse together... and still nothing. By this point, Adora was starting to think it was pointless.

Maybe she should have given it up after that time in the training yard. All of this was likely some kind of wild goose chase anyway... and yet Adora still had that gut feeling that Madam Razz had been telling the truth. Well, it was clear that no matter what, Adora and Swift Wind weren't going to fuse.

"Ugh, we aren't fusing!" She groaned in exasperation, giving up and plopping down onto the floor. She sighed, plopping her chin onto her hand.

"Maybe... Maybe we aren't meant to fuse," Swift Wind admitted. "I mean, let's face it, I'm just a big dumb annoying horse. I'm not exactly a great warrior."

Looking over at her horse friend, Adora petted his snout. She may have been feeling like garbage right now, but that didn't mean Swift Wind did. "Swifty, you're one of my best friends. I couldn't have asked for a better steed to carry me into battle... but maybe Madam Razz did get her facts wrong. Maybe it's impossible. Or maybe there's something wrong with us that means we can't fuse even if we wanted to."

"At least we tried though, right?" The horse replied. "Trying is a good thing!"

"Yeah... it is," Adora admitted, before accepting her flaws and getting up. "Alright, let's head for home then. Maybe Catra's back by now and I can get some nice warm hugs from her."

Just then, Adora heard the sound of her communicator beeping. She went to her backpack and took it out, a small hologram of Glimmer appearing. She looked scared and very concerned.

"Adora! We've got a crisis!" She shouted.

"Glimmer? What's wrong?!" Adora exclaimed. "Are you okay?!"

"Catra's onboard a Horde Ship that's gonna crash into Brgihtmoon!" She shouted. "You need to get here now! We're evacuating the castle!"

"What?!" Adora exclaimed. "No, I have to save Catra, maybe I can stop that ship before-"

"No, I need you to focus on saving the civilians!" Glimmer stated firmly.

"But Catra-"

"Is doing her best to buy us some time," Glimmer finished. "Please, Adora, we need you right now! That ship is gonna crash in the next ten minutes!"

"Right, on my way!" Adora said. She felt anxiety rising in her chest, that Catra was going to die and she was powerless to do anything. She should have gone to Brightmoon to help... but part of her wondered if there was a way that everyone could be saved, that Catra wouldn't be able to die.

She looked at Swift Wind again and then at herself. She remembered Catra's words to her before they shared their first kiss, how she had never given up on anyone and she wasn't going to give up on Catra now or ever. She sternly looked forward, a renewed determination surging through her.

"Uhhh, Adora?" Swift Wind asked. "Hate to break it to you, but we kinda need to get going!"

"There's another way," Adora insisted.

"What?"

"There's a way to save Catra and Brightmoon," Adora argued. "If we fuse... Maybe I'll gain your ability to fly. With my magic, I'll be fast enough to catch that ship and stop it from crashing."

"Adora, we haven't been able to fuse!" Swift Wind shouted. "There's no way we're gonna be able to figure this out in time!"

"We have to try!" Adora argued, tears forming in her eyes. "Swifty, please! The woman I love is gonna die and if there's a

chance of saving her, I have to take it! I can't lose her!... not again."

Swift Wind sighed. "Alright, alright."

"Okay," Adora said softly as she petted Swift Wind's snout, "let's try this again." She summoned the sword of protection, gripping it tightly. Looking at the blade, she could swear the blade glowed a bit brighter, as if the spirits of past She-Ras were guiding her, telling her to go and save the woman she loved. But she then closed her eyes, purging those thoughts from her mind.

Swift Wind did the same, their bodies starting to glow with magical light, both of them perfectly in sync. When Adora's eyes opened, she knew it was time.

"You ready?" she asked.

"Always," Swift Wind assured, standing proudly by Adora's side. "It's fusing time!"

Smiling, she turned back to the sword, her grin shifting to a serious gaze. Taking the sword in both hands, she raised it above her head, and declared, "FOR THE HONOUR OF GRAYSKULL!"

In a brilliant corona of light and colour, Adora began to change. Her flaxen hair shifted to a brighter, more golden blonde, her already well-toned body bulked up, turning her from a lean woman to a muscular Amazon. Her clothes shattered into pixels of light, swirling around her like a galaxy before reforming into her golden and white armour. However, as her tiara began to form, ribbons of energy instead wrapped themselves completely around her, appearing almost as if it was a magical cocoon. With a flash of light, the cocoon opened, turning into a beautiful pair of shimmering rainbow feathered wings, each one as long as She-Ra was tall.

As the magic around her died down, Adora gracefully landed on her feet, a look of determination on her face. With a blink, Adora gazed over the sudden new additions to her form.

"No. Way," she murmured, flexing the wings in reflex, watching as they fluttered and rustled. "We did it!" she exclaimed, jumping in and down in elation. "We did it buddy!" she squealed.

"Eh, not exactly," the voice of Swift Wind said, from behind her. Quickly turning, Adora caught sight of her friend standing before her, looking pretty much unchanged, except for one, major alteration: he was lacking his wings.

"Huh, I guess that's what happens when we do this, " Adora realised.

"You'll be giving my wings back, right?" the horse assumed.

"Of course!" Adora chirped. "I don't intend to keep these forever."

She spread out her wings, floating in the air for a moment. Eventually, she managed to get the hang of it, flying out of the ruin and into the open. She giggled, elated at the sensation of flight.

However, she then remembered she had a more pressing matter to deal with.

Wasting no time, Adora took off, the wind rushing past her as she flew away. The thrill of flight was exhilarating, the feeling of freedom she was experiencing made her think she could do anything.

A sudden boom broke her from her elation, as she looked up and saw the rapidly falling Horde ship fall in her direction. With a determined nod, she quickly flew up into the sky above, fully intent on saving not just her friends, but most importantly, the woman she loved.

Meanwhile, outside of Brightmoon, the kingdom and its citizens had been fully evacuated with the help of Bow and the other princesses. Spinnerella and Glimmer were flying and teleporting

people from the castle to the safe zone near the edge of the whispering woods.

As Glimmer teleported a few of the servants, she looked up, seeing the gigantic horde ship streaking through the sky, about to impact the castle at any moment. Just the sight of it sent a wave of horror through her form, as the ship was about to utterly destroy the only home she'd ever known.

"You sure we're at a safe distance, Bow?" Glimmer wondered.

"More or less!" Bow called out.

Perfuma and Mermista then arrived, having carried some more civilians to safety with their respective abilities, Perfuma on the back of a plant titan while Mermista had used a combination of a massive wave and one of Sea hawk's boats to carry some civilians.

"Okay, I think we have everyone out!" Mermista exclaimed. "I suggest we get to cover!"

Perfuma gazed up at the sky, seeing the horde ship about to crash. She felt disheartened, knowing her own girlfriend, Scorpia, was onboard the crashing ship. Despite all the happy times they shared, it was all going to come to an end in a massive fireball. The tears started to form in her eyes.

"Scorpia..." she said somberly.

Bow put his arm around her. "Her death won't be in vain, Perfuma. Neither will Catras or Entraptas. They've bought us enough time to get everyone out."

Glimmer growled, looking around. "Where's Adora got to?! She's supposed to be helping us!"

Meanwhile, on the bridge of the crashing ship, Catra was still clutching onto the controls in her hands, trying to keep the ship steady. She knew Glimmer and the others would have evacuated

Brightmoon now. From the cracked windows of the bridge, she could see the rest of the ship, engulfed in flames from the re-entry.

Sighing, Catra hated that she was going to die like this. She imagined dying with Adora at her side, peaceful at a ripe old age. But she supposed this was an honourable sacrifice, since she was going to die a hero. She'd saved everyone and well... maybe Adora would be proud of that.

Catra watched as the surface of Etheria approached her rapidly. Any minute now and they'd crash.

Entrapta, Scorpia and Wrong Hordak were all huddled around her tightly, each of them expecting the inevitable.

"If this is the end... I want you to know that you guys are the best friends a scorpion could ever ask for!" Scorpia cried out.

"And you're my best friends too!" Entrapta added.

Catra was about to accept her fate, but then she noticed a light on the horizon, something flying towards them at great speed. It was a mixture of different colours, but it was travelling at a speed even Catra didn't think was possible.

"W-What is that?" She asked.

"Is it a bird?" Wrong Hordak asked.

"Or a plane?" Entrapta added.

"No..." Scorpia said, as the light became clearer. "IT'S SHE-RA!"

The group stared in awe as Adora, with her sparkling rainbow wings spread out wide flew towards them faster than a speeding laser bolt. She flew towards the bridge, her wings helping her avoid the debris falling around her. As she arrived at the bridge using her sword to slash open the glass and fly inside. Catra had to take a moment to stare at how angelic she looked.

And then she recognised those wings. Swift Wind's wings. Adora had actually done it.

"You ladies need a lift?" she said smugly.

"Y-Yes!" Catra stuttered.

"Holy moly!" Scorpia exclaimed.

Quickly, Adora flew over to them, scooping Catra, Entrapta and Wrong Hordak in her beefy arms and letting Scorpia cling onto her back. The arachnid clung on tight, as the bridge exploded around them.

"Everybody on?" Adora asked.

"Yeah, now get going!" Catra ordered.

Nodding, Adora flew out of the bridge, Scorpia screaming as Adora flew with her magically enhanced speed. She flew down to the ground below, where Glimmer and the other princesses had evacuated the civilians, her gorgeous wings radiating an aura that made everyone stare up in wonder.

"Adora?!" Glimmer exclaimed. "Is that you?!"

"You managed to fuse with Swift Wind!" Bow cheered.

Catra grunted, as she landed back on the ground, Entraptra, Scorpia and Wong Hordak disembarking as well. She looked up in the sky, seeing the ship was still going to crash. "Uhhh... I hate to break up the fangirling here, but the ship is still crashing!"

"I'll handle it!" Adora declared, spreading her wings wide and taking off again.

She flew straight towards the rapidly approaching ship, staring it down like it were another enemy. She knew she only had one chance to stop this ship, or else all of Brightmoon will be lost. With no hesitation, she charged forth, drawing her sword and

charging it. As she did, the blade grew, lengthening and expanding to nearly half the size of the falling ship. She knew she only had one chance at this, so she had to destroy this ship now. With a deafening roar, she swung the massive blade, burying it deep into the ship's hull, and dragged it through the ship, cleaving it cleanly down the middle.

She pulled the blade free from the wreckage, letting it shrink back to it's regular size, and turned to watch the wreck separate into two even halves, each one turning away from Brightmoon. As the halves fell away, she rushed forth, swinging her blade savagely, slicing the large ship halves into much smaller pieces. When the hull was reduced to sizable chunks, she charged the blade again, channelling all her magic at the tip. As she charged, a glowing ball of magic, shimmering like a star, began to form and expand before her. When the orb was large enough, she swung her blade forward, screaming as she did so. The sphere flew to the centre of the falling debris, and grew until it consumed all the metal. When the last piece was absorbed, it shifted from a shimmering platinum colour to an angry red before detonating with a deafening explosion, pushing back any clouds and smaller unabsorbed debris for miles around. She watched with a satisfied smile as the sky cleared, golden sunlight shining down on her and reflecting a rainbow around her and her wings.

Looking down below her, she saw and heard everyone cheering for their hero. Once again, She-Ra had saved the day and the world was eternally grateful. But most of all, to Adora, Catra was safe once more. She then floated down to join her beloved, knowing the cris was over.

Catra watched as Adora descended on her wings of golden, magical light, gazing at her with love and awe. Her cheeks turned bright red. She hadn't seen a sight like this since the first time she'd seen Adora transform and if she was honest... the wings made Adora look even more beautiful.

Adora landed on the ground, walking over to Catra slowly. She stroked her cheek, tilting her head upwards.

"Hey there, " Adora said flirtily, relieved to be with her love again.

"Hey yourself, " Catra replied, lovingly. She reached up, gently feeling the feathers on Adora's wings. "Nice wings. Looks like that whole fusing thing worked after all."

Adora giggled. "You know... If I keep saving you like this, I think folks are gonna start thinking you're a damsel in distress."

"Maybe... But I'd be lying if I said I hated your big blonde butt coming to my rescue, " Catra teased, as Adora was about to lean in for a kiss. Oh, she had missed her favourite blonde dummy all too much.

Just then, the tender moment was interrupted by Swift Wind galloping onto the scene, sprinting past everyone and rushing up to Adora and Catra.

"I... Ooof... I made it!" he panted. "Oh man... I forgot how much of a pain in the ass running was. These legs weren't exactly built for speed. Is it over? Everything okay?"

Adora smiled. "Yes, Swifty, everything is good now."

"Yay! Now can I have my wings back? I much prefer flying to walking."

Adora nodded, transforming out of her She-Ra form, Swift Wind's wings being transferred back to him.

"Oh, thank God!" Swift Wind exclaimed as he stretched out his wings. "Wings, I missed you so goddamn much!"

"I did say I was gonna give them back, buddy," Adora replied, as Catra clung onto her like a koala.

"Yeah," he said before giving her a skeptical look. "But would you have given back before or after you flew away with Catra in your arms?"

Adora quickly clammed up.

Catra couldn't help but laugh. "You are such a dork!" she snickered.

"And a hero?" she asked lightly, almost like a child.

Sighing, Catra took Adora's face in her hands, and told you "my hero," before leaning forward and kissing her lovingly.

The entire crowd around them cheered, Glimmer and Bow watching on with surprise while a reunited Perfuma and Scorpia shared a passionate kiss. Finally, the crisis was over and Brightmoon and Etheria were once again safe, this time thanks to the power of both She-Ra and her steed.

Sometime later, everyone had returned to Brightmoon. With the crisis over, everyone was free to resume their normal lives. Up in one of the rooms of the castle, Adora was telling her friends what it was like to fly, regaling them with every detail of her rather fascinating experience.

She was resting against Swift Wind and Catra was nuzzled up on her lap purring softly, Adora scratching the fluff behind her ears instinctively, not wanting to be apart from the woman he adored for even a second. Catra meant so much to her and she was glad she was in her life once more.

"And I felt so powerful too!" Adora explained. "Like I was actually stronger with those wings, if you can believe it."

Glimmer chuckled. "Now I'm jealous that my wings barely grew beyond little tiny stumps."

"Wait, you have wings?" Scorpia asked.

"Tiny ones, " Glimmer explained. "I was always pissed I never got to have big poofy ones like my mom but well, that's hybrid genetics for you."

"Hey!" Catra chimed in, lying on Adora's lap and getting scritches behind her ears. "Can we save it with the fangirling on my girlfriend's big wings and be thankful she saved the day again?"

"I second that!" Scorpia chirped.

"And I third it!" Perfuma added, cuddling up to Scorpia. "If Adora hadn't saved us all, I'd have lost the most beautiful woman on this planet."

Scorpia blushed. "Wildflower..."

Perfuma then kissed her on the cheek. "Well, it's true!"

Adora had to giggle, before she stroked Catra again. "And I'm just glad this pretty kitty is safe in my arms again." She scritched Catra's ears and she purred again.

"Mmmmm... I would claw you for saying that in front of everyone..." Catra murmured in content. "But right now, I'm just glad to be alive with you."

"Glad to hear," Adora said softly as she returned to scratching behind Catra's ears. She smiled as she heard her girlfriend purr, loving the soft sound she made and the gentle vibrations she felt. Leaning down, she then planted a soft kiss on Catra's forehead as they laid together.

"I'm still in a bit of shock from seeing you with wings, Adora," Perfuma then said. "You looked beautiful."

"Almost like an Angel," Scorpia added.

"Or a goddess!" Bow chimed in.

"Thank you, thank you," Adora said humbly.

"Alright, enough mushy stuff," Catra groaned as she stretched herself out. "I want my girlfriend to take me on a private flight, just the two of us."

Adora blushed, already imagining what Catra had in store for her if they went for a flight. And the worst part of all of it: she realised that she wanted it. Quickly picking herself up, she gently pushed her girlfriend off of her. "I'll be right back," she quickly says as she power walked to the window.

Glimmer rolled her eyes. "You two are a real big pair of dorks, you know that?" she asks in light exasperation, before giggling.

"Hey, I almost died today and this blonde goofball saved me, I think we've earned a moment to ourselves," Catra replied, smirking at Adora. "And besides, I know I'm irresistible to Adora. It's why she can't stay away from me."

"I thought they were saying you were irresponsible," Scorpia says in confusion.

"I think you mean irritable," Perfuma says under her breath.

"More like intolerable," Glimmer groans.

Adora looked over at Swift Wind, who was devouring a basket of apples next to them. "Hey Swifty, you needing those wings right now?"

He chuckled. "Nah go ahead."

Adora quickly transformed, Swift Wind's wings vanishing and appearing on her back in her She-Ra form. Leaning down, she picked up Catra, who curled up in her muscular embrace. The catgirl smirked at Glimmer, her tail coiled around Adora's bicep as a show of power.

"See you in a bit, Sparkles, " she said before Adora took off into the sky.

Today Adora could have almost lost Catra, and lost Brightmoon as well. But thanks to her new power, she had been able to save pretty much everyone. As she and Catra flew into the sky, she

pulled her lover into a kiss above the clouds, knowing that Etheria was once again safe.

Chapter End Notes

> And so we wrap up this little tale of Adora and Swift Wind fusing as one! I feel like it was obvious that it would result in Adora getting wings but eh, the wings are pretty damn awesome. If anyone draws art of winged She-Ra ill be very happy lol
>
> Anyway, if you liked the fic please be sure to comment!

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